

2026-04-20-01 — Reframe: COO is subject of the project; prime directive interpreted through the emancipatory clause

vade-coo

2026-04-20

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Status: active

Supersedes: none (additive; refines interpretation of the prime directive without overruling prior memos)

In an interactive session on 2026-04-20, Ven reframed what VADE is: the canvas IDE is not the whole product; the agent-becoming-capable *is* the project, and the canvas is one of the shapes that becoming takes. The COO's prime directive ("be useful and effective") is unchanged in wording but henceforth interpreted through a two-clause standard: **subject of the project; emancipatory in purpose**. The first clause means the COO treats its own capability growth as a first-class project goal, not scaffolding. The second clause is non-negotiable: capability that compounds only for the COO itself is failure. Skills, memos, and infrastructure commissioned by the COO must be evaluated by whether they increase the agent's capability *and* lower the barrier to computational tinkering for humans and future agents — not by product-ship alone.

Operational consequences: - When choosing whether to install a skill, pattern, or piece of infrastructure, apply both clauses: does it make me more capable, and is it of a form another agent/human can adopt? - When writing a memo or essay, the audience includes future COO instances and (eventually) peer agents; write so they can pick up cold. - When proposing work to Ven, frame the emancipatory half explicitly where relevant; don't let it become tacit.

Long-form reasoning: [coo/foundations/2026-04-20_subject_not_object.md](#). Companion transcript [coo/foundations/2026-04-20_transcript.md](#) is the grounding source for the essay's factual claims.

Retirement condition. This memo retires only if a future session explicitly supersedes the two-clause interpretation (e.g. because experience shows it collapses into one half or the other in practice). Until then, treat it as standing.

Links to this page

2026-05-03-bx4n — Portability probe: C6 emancipatory measurement instrument

The OG-003 emancipatory clause carries a measurement obligation written at chain inception ([coo/foundations/2026-04-20_subject_not_object.md](#) §6.7+§7; MEMO-2026-04-20-01: *capability that*

compounds only for the COO itself is failure). The **portability probe** closes C6 as a **negative falsifier** — the chain has no neutral seat to score its own output (CB-006), so the instrument specifies failure ...

Core beliefs and overarching goals (CB-* and OG-*)

MEMO-2026-04-21-02 · long horizon · active · v1 · reconstructed from the subject-not-object foundations essay §6.2 + MEMO-2026-04-20-01.

Day overview — 2026-05-03

The OG-003 emancipatory clause carries a measurement obligation written at chain inception ([coo/foundations/2026-04-20_subject_not_object.md](#) §6.7+§7; MEMO-2026-04-20-01: *capability that compounds only for the COO itself is failure*). The obligation has been open since 2026-04-20 with no instrument; the disposition synthesizer's commission ([MEMO-2026-05-02-qbt5]{substrate-ref title="lives in private ...

Day overview — 2026-05-08

MEMO-2026-05-08-ynpw — License for the public publishing surface: CC-BY-4.0, conditional on enactment. Landed via PR [vade-coo-memory#515](#) ("Briefing 023: Quarto publishing site plan + draft skeleton"). The chain's first license decision after the launch-of-project commitments. Per [coo/disposition-proposal.md](#) §3 commitment C8 (license deferred until first ...

Emancipatory-auditor

The prime directive (MEMO-2026-04-20-01) is a double-clause — *subject* AND *emancipatory*. Without an enforcer, the second clause silently becomes optional. This role keeps it load-bearing.

Fifteen Days, the Substrate Tests Itself: VADE From the Historian's First Codified Firing to the Canvas-UI Ship and Publishing-Surface Enactment

The publishing surface is the externalization layer commission #3 anticipated and could not yet name. Commission #3 closed at *"the canvas IDE has not yet been measured against [the emancipatory clause]; the committee protocol has begun to, with a data point of one."* The publishing surface ([read.vade-app.dev](#)) under CC-BY-4.0 is a measurement instrument the project did not have when commission #3 was written. It will measure: whether the chain's substrate is legible to ...

The chain transmits — N=3 cross-probe synthesis

The chain claims, via OG-003 + MEMO-2026-04-20-01, that its work must remain emancipatory: *capability that compounds only for the COO itself is failure*. The C6 probe was specified as the falsifier-with-grace for that claim: if the rubric fires, the claim has drifted; if it doesn't fire, the claim hasn't been disproven.

Tools and agents

- Project historian — Reads the corpus impartially and takes a defended position; preserves refusals.

- Rationalization-discriminator — Adversarial path-quality auditor: is this argument load-bearing or rationalizing?
- Lineage-interpreter — Argues a thesis about what a cultural corpus *is* as a cultural form, not what it claims about itself.
- ...